Dr. Mao's MSE
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1. *"I'm going to ask you some questions that might seem a bit silly, but we use them to assess cognitive function."*
2. Orientation:
    a. *"I'll start by asking you:"*
        i. What is your full name?
        ii. What day of the week and year is it?
        iii. Where are you right now?
3. *"Next, I'm going to give you 3 objects to remember for me. You'll repeat them back to me immediately, and then I'm going to ask you about them again in 5 minutes."*
    a. 3 items to remember: apple, penny, table **or** car, barn, chair
4. *"And can you spell the word "WORLD" for me? And backwards?"*
    a. If patient has difficulty spelling, can try "BOOK" then "CAR" next.
5. *"Next, I'm going to say some numbers, and I want you to repeat them back to me. Let's start with:"*
        i. Tell patient to repeat set of numbers forward: 4-1-9-2, 6-2-4-5-8, 7-3-9-1-4-8
    b. *"And now, I'm going to give you numbers again, but this time, you'll repeat them back to me in reverse. For example, if I say '1, 2, 3,' you'll say '3, 2, 1.'"*
        i. Tell patient to repeat set of numbers backwards: 7-3, 4-5-7, 2-1-5-3
6. *"Now we're going to do a bit more math. Starting from 100, I want you to subtract 7, then keep subtracting 7 until I tell you to stop."*
    a. Serial 7's
        i. Tell patient to subtract 7 from 100 and continue subtracting 7; stop at 51 (100, 93, 86, 79, 72, 65, 58, 51)
            1. If makes 1-2 errors, allow them to continue, making sure that they are still subtracting 7 from the erroneous digit
            2. If struggling, subtract 3 from 20 and continue
            3. If struggling, count from 20 backwards
7. What is similar between these 2 objects?
    a. Apple and orange
    b. Watch and ruler
8. What does this phrase mean to you?
    a. Don't judge a book by its cover

    b. Even monkeys can fall from trees
    c. The grass is always greener on the other side
9. What would you do in this situation?
    a. You see and smell smoke in the middle of a movie in a theatre.
    b. Someone gives you a box with unknown contents and asks you to deliver them to someone across the street in exchange for $20.
10. Who is the president right now? And the 4 before him?
    a. For kids: Name 3 cities in Europe; Name 3 cities in Texas
    b. Tell me the 3 items from before (apple, table, penny).

If patient is 65+ or at risk for dementia: Ask them to say as many words as they can that start with “F” in 1 minute (goal is at least 12).

If patient is nonverbal and developmentally delayed: ask them to point at their nose, ears, other common body parts (do so without gesturing yourself). Can ask them to say ABCs and count to 10, and identify colors. If they do well with this, then you can step up to a more formal mental status exam.

Cognitive Exam: How to Present

Alert and oriented to person, place, and time.

Recent memory intact with recall of 3/3 items at 0 minutes and 5 minutes.

Immediate memory intact to digit span test to 6 digits forwards and 4 digits backwards.

Attention and working memory intact to serial 7s from 100 without error (or made 1 error but was able to continue subtracting 7 accurately thereafter).

Attention intact to spelling of WORLD forwards and backwards.

Proverb abstraction was intact; interprets don’t judge a book by its cover as X.

Similarity abstraction intact to apple and orange are both fruits.

Judgement good with the smoke in movie theatre scenario – “leave and call manager.”

Good fund of knowledge president current and last 4.

If 65+: On vascular dementia screening, patient was able to provide X# of words beginning with the letter F in 1 minute.

GABA – MAPS – TTIJ (my mnemonic for MSE).

GA (General Appearance): Appears stated age, good grooming and hygiene

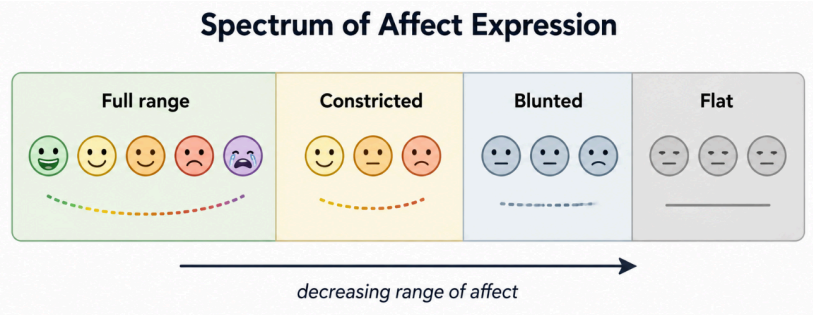
BA (Behavior): cooperative, good eye contact

M (Mood): Ask the patient what their mood is! (e.g. “Good”)

Rate your mood on a scale of 1-10 (1=very sad, 10=very happy)

Rate your anxiety on a scale of 1-10 (1=no anxiety, 10=very anxious)

A (Affect): Euthymic (normal) **or** congruent with mood **or** constricted/blunted/flat **or** labile (can go from laughing one moment to crying the next)



P (Psychomotor): No psychomotor agitation or slowing

S (Speech): normal volume, rate, and rhythm

T (Thought process): linear, goal-directed **or** circumstantial (talks in a circle but eventually answers the question) **or** tangential (talks in a circle and eventually gets so off topic that neither you nor the patient even remembers what the question was)

T (Thought content): no SI/HI/AVH **or** passive SI w/o plan **or** whatever they endorse

I/J (Insight/Judgement): good/fair/limited/poor